

Product Development Lifecycle (1-1)

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1. Idea Generation - It doesn't always start with an idea, but more so starts with a problem. Recognition of a problem, the definition of it, and a solution proposal follows. There are typically 4-12 people (2 pizza rule). The quantity of ideas is more important than the quality. The expected output is a list of ideas and a document capturing everything that was discussed. Participants typically include PMs, designers, engineers, and, in larger companies, the marketing teams join in.
2. Discovery and validation - After coming up with ideas, you should look into these factors: target market, existing product landscape, functionality, and do a SWOT analysis. Then the next step is to conduct interviews with your customers to assess their potential. The expected output is a validated problem statement, with research findings and interview notes that tell us whether to move forward or not. Participants typically include PMs, designers, and marketers.
3. Market Research - Market research blends consumer behaviour and economic trends to validate and refine your ideas. You need to analyze market size, trends, customer demographics, and existing solutions. The expected output is a report containing competitor analysis, target audience profiles, and key trends that inform product decisions. Participants typically include PMs, marketing teams, and UX researchers.
4. Requirements Gathering - It's the process of collecting, documenting, and understanding what the product needs to do. It helps define features, expectations, and constraints so the final product aligns with business goals and user needs. The expected output is a PRD and/or MRD that outlines features, constraints, and goals of the product. Participants typically include PMs, engineers, stakeholders, and customers.
5. UX/UI Design - This includes creating wireframes, prototypes, and mockups that define how the product looks and feels. The expected output is a finalized design system that engineers can use to build the product. Participants typically include PMs, designers, and engineers.
6. Development - Engineers use the PRD and design field as a blueprint to build the product. This stage follows a three-tier architecture: the presentation layer, application layer, and data layer. Participants typically include engineers overseen by a technical lead, and PMs stay involved to ensure the product is being built to the requirements.
7. Testing and Q/A - Products usually go through 2 test phases - alpha(internal) and beta(target users). It involves checking the product for functional and performance testing. The expected output is a tested and approved product with a bug report. Participants typically include developers, engineers, and users.
8. Deployment - It is the final stage of the product's life cycle. The final product is made available to the users, and it can be pushed out all at once or gradually through a staged rollout.

The expected output is a live, publicly accessible product. Participants include engineers, devs, and PMs.

9. Monitoring and iteration - It involves tracking the product's performance after launch. Teams analyze data, collect user feedback, and identify areas for improvement. The expected output is a set of performance reports, user feedback summaries, and an updated product backlog of improvements and new features to be built in the next cycle. Participants typically include PMs, engineers, and marketing teams.

Sources :

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